Rana Shehada

Curriculum Designer & Lead Facilitator · Program & Portfolio Management
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SUMMARY

Peacebuilding and international development professional with 12+ years across the Middle East, North Africa and the United States. Designs and facilitates conflict resolution, dialogue, mediation and civic education curricula for audiences from community groups to senior government officials; manages the programs that deliver them, including USAID and U.S. Department of State funded portfolios, subcontractor oversight, field coordination and closeouts.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Designed and facilitated a conflict resolution program for government officials and civil society with the SDG Unit of the Office of the Prime Minister of the Bahamas, and youth leadership and foresight training for international cohorts with Universiti Sains Islam Malaysia and UPEACE.
- Backstopped a $50M+ international development portfolio and led operational reviews, asset reconciliation and closeouts in project offices abroad to audit readiness; managed State Department funded civil society portfolios and their subcontractors.
- Writes the facilitator guides, workbooks and toolkits that let a session run consistently in any format; sets learning indicators and runs post-session evaluation.

CORE SKILLS

Learning design: Curriculum strategy and instructional design; adult and experiential learning; participatory, interest-based and trauma-informed methods; facilitator guides, workbooks, case studies, toolkits

Facilitation: Lead facilitation and co-facilitation in person and online (Zoom, Google Classroom); dialogue and mediation

Program management: Portfolio backstopping; subcontractor scopes of work and deliverable review; work plans against donor benchmarks; budgets, financial models and variance reporting; field start-ups and closeouts

Monitoring and evaluation: Learning indicators; milestone tracking with qualitative reporting; post-session evaluation; DME

Compliance: USAID and U.S. Department of State funded programs; federal contract management; audit readiness; HEAT

Languages: Arabic and English, bilingual

EXPERIENCE

Curriculum Developer & Lead Facilitator
2019 – Present

Independent practice · *USA, international and virtual.*

- Design and deliver adult learning curricula, interactive workshops and leadership and dialogue modules for international cohorts, civic leaders, academic institutions and multilateral bodies.
- Author facilitator guides, lesson plans, participant workbooks, case studies and discussion toolkits so that quality is consistent across delivery formats.
- Adapt core modules to regional and socio-cultural contexts with participatory exercises, trauma-informed principles and interest-based frameworks; define learning indicators and refine each course from post-session evaluation.
- Programs: Conflict Resolution for Government Officials & Civil Society (with the SDG Unit, Office of the Prime Minister of the Bahamas); Youth, Foresight & Civic Education (Values 2021; USIM and UPEACE); Mediation for Families, Workplace & Communities; Navigating Traditions & Cultural Dynamics (George Mason University); Learning Islamic Guidance for Human Tolerance & Peacebuilding.

Program Officer May 2024 – Feb 2025

DT Institute · *Washington, DC, hybrid.*

- Operational, contractual and technical management of multi-million-dollar civil society and community resilience portfolios funded by the U.S. Department of State.
- Oversaw subcontractor scopes of work; reviewed and vetted technical deliverables and capacity-building milestones against donor standards and program objectives.
- Coordinated daily with multidisciplinary teams, institutional partners and technical experts across regions to keep implementation on schedule and remove procedural bottlenecks.
- Combined quantitative milestone tracking with qualitative reporting; periodic pipeline and progress analyses for leadership.

Senior Program Associate Dec 2021 – May 2024

Creative Associates International · *Washington, DC.*

- Operational, financial and technical backstopping across a $50M+ international development portfolio spanning several regional operating environments.
- Coordinated field implementation teams and local offices, aligning work plans with donor benchmarks and monitoring resource allocation against target results.
- Deployed to international project offices to lead operational reviews, asset reconciliation and closeout protocols; standardized workflows to audit readiness.
- Developed standardized reporting templates, financial models and variance summaries for partners and executive leadership.

Publications Project Manager / Coordinator Dec 2016 – Nov 2021

International Institute of Islamic Thought (IIIT) · *Herndon, VA.*

- Managed end-to-end editorial, production and dissemination workflows for academic and educational materials across U.S., UK and regional offices.
- Established standard operating procedures, version control and onboarding documentation for contributors.
- Ran peer-review cycles and production timelines with international subject matter experts, within budget and quality parameters.

Program Manager 2015 – 2017

WaSeala · *Reston, VA and virtual. Co-founded educational platform connecting educators and learners.*

- Recruited, coordinated and onboarded 20+ professionals and volunteers contributing to an interactive community educational platform.
- Formulated operational roadmaps, semi-annual budgets and participant feedback evaluations that drove platform and content improvements.

EDUCATION

M.S. Conflict Analysis and Resolution · Carter School for Peace and Conflict Resolution, George Mason University

B.A. English Literature · Ain Shams University, Cairo, Egypt

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

Project Design, Monitoring and Evaluation (DME) · Federal & USAID Contract Management for Program Managers · Hostile Environment Awareness Training (HEAT) · Project Plans 101 & Integrated Schedule Management